

pasting, we didn't get the desired result, probably due to a bug), to appending videos, to converting across video formats. Avidemux offers shortcuts to automate setting various codec options when creating content suitable for viewing on different video devices such as DVD players or PlayStation Portable; thus freeing the user from these technical details.

VirtualDub ([www.virtualdub.org](http://www.virtualdub.org)) is a bit more polished than Avidemux, but cannot be run natively in Linux.

### 2.2.3 DVD authoring

DVD styler (<http://dvdstyler.de/>)

This is an open source video DVD authoring tool that is available for both – Linux and Windows platforms. While not a professional level application, it is feature laden to help easily author video DVDs. The interface is quite user-friendly, and most tasks can be accomplished with clicks and by drag and drop.

With an integrated file browser, media files can be dragged and dropped into the time line. Clips can be shuffled and their properties modified. DVDStyler also comes preloaded with a few background images and buttons styles that can be used to create a menu, which can be further customised by the user. DVDStyler can convert videos into the default DVD standard (MPEG2) while mastering the DVD. So you don't need any prior conversion – AVI files can be directly dragged on to the time line, and are converted to MPEG2 on the fly. The final output can also be written to a DVD with the integrated burner. The application comes with a help file that is too brief, so a user is better off downloading the user guide available online to learn how to use this application at its fullest potential.



Open source aficionados will do well to take a look at other acclaimed video editing suites such as Jahshaka (<http://jahshaka.org/>), Kino ([www.kinodv.org/](http://www.kinodv.org/)) and Cinerella (<http://cvs.cinelerra.org/>) – the latter two are only available under Linux.

InfraRecorder (<http://infrarecorder.org/>)

While Linux users have had feature rich media burners bundled with the operating system, the one bundled with Windows is minimal. InfraRecorder, a Windows only open source